

Arabic Consonants on the IPA Table ¹

	Manner	Nasal	Plosive		Fricative		Trill	Approximant
Place			Unvoiced ¹	Voiced	Unvoiced	Voiced		
◌Labial		◌م [mīm, m]		◌ب [bā', b]	◌ف [fā', f] (labiodental)			
◌Dental					◌ث [thā', θ]	◌ذ [dhāl, ð]		
◌Denti-Alveolar	plain	◌ن [nūn, n]	◌ت [tā', t]	◌د [dāl, d]	◌س [sīn, s]	◌ز [zāy, z]	◌ر [rā', r]	◌ل [lām, l] (Lateral Apprx.)
	emphatic		◌ط [ṭā', ṭʰ]	◌ض [ḍād, dʰ]	◌ص [ṣād, sʰ]	◌ظ [ẓā', ẓʰ]		◌ل [lām, ɫ] (as in Allah)
Post-Alveolar/Palatal				◌ج ([jīm, d͡ʒ]) ◌*	◌ش [shīn, ʃ] ◌*			◌ي [yā', j] ◌*
◌Velar			◌ك [kāf, k]					◌و [wāw, w] (labial-velar)
◌Uvular			◌ق [qāf, q]		◌خ [khā', χ] ^{2,3}	◌غ [ghayn, ʁ] ^{2,4}		
◌Pharyngeal					◌ح [ḥā', ḥ]	◌ع [ʿayn, ʕ]		
◌Glottal			◌أ [hamza, ʔ]		◌ه [hā', h]			

¹ ت [tā', t] and ك [kāf, k] are aspirated [tʰ] and [kʰ], whereas ط [ṭā', ṭʰ] and ق [qāf, q] are unaspirated.

² In most regions, uvular fricatives of the classical period have become velar or post-velar.

³ خ the sound /χ/ (as in German “Bach”) is uvular, versus /x/ (as in “loch”) is velar.

⁴ غ the sound /ʁ/ (close to French “merde”) is uvular, versus /ɣ/ (close to Spanish “amigo”) is velar.

Arabic Vowels and Other Signs

Vowels	Short	◌َ [faṭḥa, a]	◌ِ [kasra, i]	◌ُ [ḍamma, u]
	Long	◌َ◌ [faṭḥa + alif, a:]	◌ِ◌ [kasra + yā', i:]	◌ُ◌ [ḍamma + wāw, u:]

Other Signs:	◌◌◌ [tanwīn faṭḥa, an]	◌◌◌ [tanwīn kasra, in]	◌◌◌ [tanwīn ḍamma, un]	◌◌◌ [sukūn, ʔ]	◌◌◌ [shadda, :]
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¹This table was based off of Wikipedia's Arabic phonology article https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Standard_Arabic_phonology#Consonants and added to by Justin Lowe. Last Updated: 2025-09-17

Arabic Alphabet Chart with all written forms ²

Isolated	Final	Medial	Initial	Name ¹	IPA	Articulation
ا	ـا			alif	[a:]	(Nil. Bearer for <i>hamza</i> or sign of a long <i>ā</i>)
ب	ـب	ـبـ	بـ	bāʾ	[b]	labial, voiced, unaspirated
ت	ـت	ـتـ	تـ	tāʾ	[t]	dental, unvoiced, unaspirated
ث	ـث	ـثـ	ثـ	thāʾ	[θ]	dental, unvoiced, unaspirated
ج	ـج	ـجـ	جـ	jīm	[d͡ʒ]	palatal, voiced, unaspirated
ح	ـح	ـحـ	حـ	ḥāʾ	[ħ]	pharyngeal, unvoiced, unaspirated
خ	ـخ	ـخـ	خـ	khāʾ	[χ]	velar, unvoiced, unaspirated
د	ـد			dāl	[d]	dental, voiced, unaspirated
ذ	ـذ			dhāl	[ð]	dental, voiced, unaspirated
ر	ـر			rāʾ	[r]	alveolar, voiced, unaspirated
ز	ـز			zāy	[z]	alveolar, voiced, unaspirated
س	ـس	ـسـ	سـ	sīn	[s]	alveolar, unvoiced, unaspirated
ش	ـش	ـشـ	شـ	shīn	[ʃ]	palatal, unvoiced, unaspirated
ص	ـص	ـصـ	صـ	ṣād	[sˤ]	emphatic dental, unvoiced, unaspirated
ض	ـض	ـضـ	ضـ	ḍād	[dˤ]	emphatic dental, voiced, unaspirated
ط	ـط	ـطـ	طـ	ṭāʾ	[tˤ]	emphatic dental, unvoiced, unaspirated
ظ	ـظ	ـظـ	ظـ	ẓāʾ	[ðˤ]	emphatic dental, voiced, unaspirated
ع	ـع	ـعـ	عـ	ʿayn	[ʕ]	pharyngeal, voiced, unaspirated
غ	ـغ	ـغـ	غـ	ghayn	[ɣ]	velar, voiced, unaspirated
ف	ـف	ـفـ	فـ	fāʾ	[f]	labial, unvoiced, unaspirated
ق	ـق	ـقـ	قـ	qāf	[q]	uvular, unvoiced, unaspirated
ك	ـك	ـكـ	كـ	kāf	[k]	velar, unvoiced, unaspirated
ل	ـل	ـلـ	لـ	lām	[l]	alveolar, voiced, unaspirated
م	ـم	ـمـ	مـ	mīm	[m]	labial, voiced, unaspirated
ن	ـن	ـنـ	نـ	nūn	[n]	alveolar, voiced, unaspirated
هـ	ـهـ	ـهـ	هـ	hāʾ	[h]	glottal, unvoiced, unaspirated
و	ـو			wāw	[w]	labial-velar, voiced, unaspirated
ي	ـي	ـيـ	يـ	yāʾ	[j]	palatal, voiced approximant
	ء, ؤ, إ	ء, ؤ, إ	أ, ؤ, إ	hamza ²	[ʔ]	glottal, unvoiced, unaspirated

¹ the bold letter in the name indicates the letter's typical English transliteration.

² ALA-LC: "In initial position ..., ء is not represented in romanization. When medial or final, ء is romanized as '."

Common Arabic Ligatures ³

Ligature	Components	Transliteration
لا	ل ا	lām-alif (initial/medial)
لاِ	ل اِ	lām-alif with hamza below
لأ	ل اُ	lām-alif with hamza above
لآ	ل آ	lām-alif with madda
جح	ج ح	jīm-ḥāʾ
حج	ح ج	ḥāʾ-jīm
حم	ح م	ḥāʾ-mīm
سح	س ح	sīn-ḥāʾ
صح	ص ح	ṣād-ḥāʾ
لح	ل ح	lām-ḥāʾ
بسم	ب س م	bāʾ-sīn-mīm
الله	ا ل ل ه	Allah (word ligature)
ﷺ	ص ل ل ه ع ل ي ه و س ل م	ṣallā llāhu ‘alayhi wa-sallam
رسول	ص ل ل ع م	ṣallā llāhu ‘alayhi wa-sallam (abbreviation)
أكبر	ا ك ب ر	akbar
مُحَمَّد	م ح م د	muḥammad
ﷻ	ج ل ج ل ا ل ه	jalla jalāluhu

³(List generated by AI: Claude Sonnet 3.5, not yet reviewed or added to) Last Updated: 2025-09-16 JKL